B1 Reading

Reading short messages and notices

Find who wrote a message, why, and what you need to do, in emails, texts and signs.

Short messages are everywhere: texts from friends, work emails, notices in buildings. For each one, ask three questions: **Who** wrote it? **Why**? **What** must I do?

Purpose	Typical language
Inviting	*Would you like to… ? Do you fancy… ? Are you free on…?*
Asking for something	*Could you… ? Can you remember to…?*
Changing a plan	*I'm afraid… Instead of… It's been moved to…*
Warning or rule	*Please do not… … must not… … is not allowed.*

Texts

A. Hi Sara, I'm afraid I can't make lunch tomorrow, my boss has called a meeting. Are you free on Thursday instead? Same place, 1 pm? Nora

B. NOTICE: The lift will be closed for repairs from Monday 9 to Wednesday 11 June. Please use the stairs. We are sorry for any trouble.

C. Dear all, Please remember to send me your holiday dates by Friday so I can plan the summer timetable. Thanks, Ahmed (Office Manager)

Look for the verb that asks you to act. *Please use, remember to send, are you free*: these words show what the reader must do.

Common mistake. Choosing an answer because it has a word from the text. Message A mentions *meeting*, but the message is about changing lunch plans.

Practice

1. Message A: Why is Nora writing?
2. Message A: What day does she suggest?
3. Message B: How long will the lift be closed?
4. Message B: What should people do?
5. Message C: Who is Ahmed writing to?
6. Message C: What must they do, and by when?

▼ **Show answers**

1. To cancel lunch tomorrow and suggest another day.
2. Thursday
3. Three days (Monday 9 to Wednesday 11 June)
4. Use the stairs.
5. Everyone in the office (all staff)
6. Send their holiday dates by Friday.